



women's contributions, and criticizing the objectification of women in media. Feminists such as Andrea Dworkin campaigned against pornography, arguing that it demeaned women and encouraged rape and violence. From the 1970s, "Take Back the Night" or "Reclaim the Night" marches protested and raised awareness about rape, sexual assault, and violence against women. Domestic violence also became a major issue, leading feminists to set up women's shelters and demand both police and courts work to address the problem.

In the 1960s, women were paid considerably less than men. In 1968, 200 British women workers at the Ford automobile factory in Dagenham went on strike for equal pay and brought production to a halt. In Iceland, 90 percent of the country's female workforce went on strike in October 1975 to protest wage inequality and unfair working practices; their actions led to new laws the following

◀ Marxist feminist poster

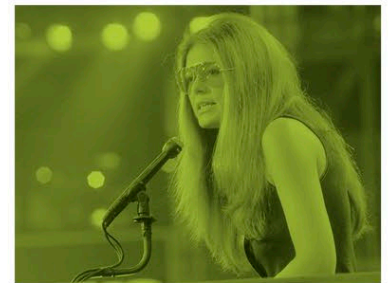
In the 1960s, Italian feminist groups brought attention to the poor treatment of communist women by their male comrades. They argued that there would be "no revolution without women's liberation."

year. Feminists highlighted the barriers facing women at work, fought for daycares at work and free childcare, and conceptualized the glass ceiling—an invisible barrier that prevented women from getting the top jobs.

'80s feminism

By the 1980s, second wave feminism was making its mark worldwide, with protests and organizations throughout Europe, in China, South America, and Asia. It was not a unified movement: it included socialist feminists, who linked the fight against oppression to the class struggle; equal rights feminists, who sought equality with men; and radical feminists who saw patriarchal society as the cause of women's oppression and argued for large-scale change. From the 1970s, women of color had criticized feminism for its predominantly white outlook, resulting in the formation of black or Asian feminist groups, such as the Combahee River Collective—a black lesbian group founded in Boston in 1974. In the 1960s in the US and the 1980s in France, lesbian activists challenged the WLM for its emphasis on heterosexuality, and some advocated for women to practice lesbianism as a political identity and means of protest.

As the 1980s gave way to the 1990s, feminism became less popular as a movement, as what some observers called a "backlash" gained traction. The failure in the US of the Equal Rights Amendment, the rise of consumerism, and neo-liberal politics caused the second wave slowly to fade away.



BIOGRAPHY

GLORIA STEINEM

A major voice of the second wave, Gloria Steinem established herself as a journalist in the early 1960s. After attending a talk on abortion, she became an active feminist, publishing *After Black Power, Women's Liberation* in 1969 and cofounding *Ms. magazine* in 1971. That same year, she also cofounded both the Women's Action Alliance and the National Women's Political Caucus. In 1979, she wrote about female genital cutting, bringing it to the attention of the American public for the first time.

"THERE IS NO ... SINGLE-
ISSUE **STRUGGLE**. WE
DO NOT LIVE SINGLE-
ISSUE **LIVES**."

AUDRE LORDE, SPEECH AT HARVARD UNIVERSITY, 1982

